

asked the people of the place, and they said unto me: 'There is no harlot here.'” And he said: “Let her keep (them) lest we become a cause of derision.” 16. And when she had completed three months, it was manifest that she was with child, and they told Judah, saying: “Behold Tamar, thy daughter-in-law, is with child by whoredom.” 17. And Judah went to the house of her father, and said unto her father and her brothers: “Bring her forth, and let them burn her, for she hath wrought uncleanness in Israel.” 18. And it came to pass when they brought her forth to burn her that she sent to her father-in-law the ring and the necklace, and the staff, saying: “Discern whose are these, for by him am I with child.” 19. And Judah acknowledged, and said: “Tamar is more righteous than I am. And therefore let them burn her not.” 20. And for that reason she was not given to Shelah, and he did not again approach her. 21. And after that

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she bare two sons, Perez and Zerah, in the seventh year of this second week. 22. And thereupon the seven years of fruitfulness were accomplished, of which Joseph spake to Pharaoh. 23. And Judah acknowledged that the deed which he had done was evil, for he had lain with his daughter-in-law, and he esteemed it hateful in his eyes, and he acknowledged that he had transgressed and gone astray; for he had uncovered the skirt of his son,

unto him.” Perhaps we should read with Latin “dicens: Non inveni eam,” “And said: I have not found her,” as I have done in my text.

*Let her keep* = tēššā’ē, emended with Latin “habeat” from tanšē’ē, “arise.”

17. *Let them burn her.* See note on xxx. 7. In Ber. rabba 85 R. Meir of the second cent. states that Tamar was a daughter of the priest-king Shem. Hence her destruction by fire came under the law in Lev. xxi. 9, which prescribes this penalty for the sin of fornication in the daughter of a priest.

In Ps.-Jon. on Gen. xxxviii. 6, 24 Tamar is called a priest's daughter. Beer (*Buch d. Jub.* p. 52) cites Baba Mezia 87 a to the same effect.

20. *Did not again approach her.* Cf. Test. Jud. 12: οὐδὲ ἤγγισα αὐτῇ ἔτι ἕως θανάτου μου.

21. Cf. Gen. xxxviii. 29, 30.

*Perez . . . Zerah.* Eth. Phârês . . . Zârâ.

22. Cf. Gen. xli. 53.

23. *Had gone astray; for he had uncovered,* etc. Cf. Test. Jud. 14: ἐποίησα ἁμαρτίαν μεγάλην, καὶ ἀνεκάλυψα κάλυμμα ἀκαθαρσίας υἱῶν μου.